EDU602

Glossary

- **Accountability**

Accountability equates to having ultimate responsibility for an area, activity, group, project, department, etc.

- **Action-Centered Leadership**

US-English, Action-Centered Leadership) A leadership model developed by English leadership expert, writer and theorist John Adair, based on three elements: Task, Team, Individual.

- **Authoritarian Leadership**

A style of leadership in which the leader tells the employees what needs to be done and how to perform it without getting their advice or ideas.

- **Autocratic leadership**

dictatorial method of leading - low concern for followers and high emphasis on task - typically reinforced with threat, punishment, and often ruthless exploitation of workers, who have little or no freedom to resist or desert. A feature of a strongly dictatorial application of the transactional leadership style.

- **Behaviour**

Often pluralized in referring to leadership behaviours, which are broadly how a leader acts - what the leader does and how the leader does it. There is a strong correlation between behaviour and style in the context of describing and understanding leadership theory. Like the word concept, and other quite vague terms, the word behaviour/behaviours needs to be clarified where it is important to understand its usage.

- **Benchmarking**

The process of measuring the organization's products, services, cost, procedures, etc. against competitors or other organizations that display a "best in class" record.

- **Culture**

The long-term complex phenomenon that can be affected by strategic leaders. Culture represents the shared expectations and self-image of the organization. The mature values that create "tradition", the play out of "climate" or "the feel of the organization" over time, and the deep, unwritten code that frames "how we do things around here" contribute to the culture. Organizational culture is a system of shared values, assumptions, beliefs, and norms that unite the members of the organization. Individual leaders cannot easily create or change culture. Differs from climate in that climate can be readily changed, whereas culture cannot be easily changed.

- **Decision-making**

The process of reaching logical conclusions, solving problems, analyzing factual information, and taking appropriate actions based on the conclusions.

- **Delegative leadership**

A style of leadership in which the leader entrusts decision-making to an employee of a group of employees. The leader is still responsible for their decisions.

- **Deming's 14 points**

Management philosophy to help organizations increase their quality and productivity: Create constancy of purpose for improving product or service. Adopt the new philosophy. Stop dependency on inspection to achieve quality End the practice of awarding business on price alone - minimize cost by working with a single vendor. Constantly improve every process for planning, production, and service. Institute training on the job. Adopt and institute leadership. Drive out fear. Break down barriers between staff areas. Eliminate slogans, exhortations, and targets for the work force. Eliminate numerical quotas and goals for the workforce and management. Remove barriers that rob people of pride in workmanship and eliminate the annual rating or merit system. Institute a vigorous program of education and self-improvement for everyone. Put everyone in the organization to work to accomplish the transformation.

- **Diversity**

Committing to establish an environment where the full potential of all employees can be tapped by paying attention to, and taking into account their differences in work background, experience,

age, gender, race, ethnic origin, physical abilities, religious belief, sexual orientation, and other perceived differences. Diversity differs from affirmative action, which is more about following laws. Diversity is a range of different people, while inclusion is making them feel welcome and being part of the group.

- **Effective leadership**

Common expression basically meaning good leadership, i.e., a leadership approach which achieves task/organizational aims while also satisfying all other needs and obligations of leadership for the situation. Since situations can change a lot for any given leader the term also implies leadership capability to adapt methods/styles, etc., in maintaining effectiveness.

- **Fiedler's Contingency Leadership Model**

A leadership theory categorised here as a Situational Contingency model, which focuses on the correlation between the leader's style (emphasis either on task or relationship) and the 'favourableness' of the situation in which the leader is leading -

- **House's Path-Goal Theory**

A leadership theory developed by Robert House, categorised here as a Situational/Contingency leadership model, in which the personal needs and benefits accruing to the group in achieving a task (goal) are correlated to a correspondingly suitable approach (path) of leading the group

- **Leadership**

The process of influencing people while operating to meet organizational requirements and improving the organization through change.

- **Leadership concept**

A rather vague term usually referring to a single theory or aspect of leadership, but used very loosely and more widely than this. The term needs clarifying and questioning if understanding its precise meaning is important.

- **Leadership Styles**

The manner and approach of providing direction, implementing plans, and motivating people.

- **Organizational behavior**

The study and application of knowledge about how people, individuals, and groups act in organizations.

- **Participative leadership**

A style of leadership in which the leader involves one or more employees in determining what to do and how to do it. The leader maintains final decision making authority.

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- **Planning**

A course of action for oneself and/or others to accomplish a goal; establishing priorities and planning appropriate allocation of time and resources and proper assignment of people to achieve feasible, acceptable, and suitable objectives.

- **Self-directed work team**

A small independent, self-organized, and self-controlling group in which members plan, organize, determine, and manage their duties and actions, as well as perform many other supportive functions.

- **Servant leadership**

A leadership concept categorized here as a leadership philosophy, in which the leader's priorities are the followers interests, and the interests of the wider situation, rather than the leader's own interests

- **Skills**

Those abilities that people develop and use with people, with ideas, and with things, hence, the division of interpersonal, cognitive, and technical skills.

- **Sources of Power**

A specific concept of leadership developed by French and Raven, categorised here as a leadership philosophy; the theory is arguably also a 'mini-model', being structured and containing flexible

correlations, of a particular dimension of leadership, notably the relationship between leader and followers and especially followers' perceptions of the leader, which determine the leader's power

- **Standard**

An established norm in which measurements are compared and evaluated. The time allowed to perform a task, including the quality and quantity of work to be produced.

- **Strategy**

The creation of a unique and valuable market position supported by a system of activities that fit together in a complementary way. It is about making choices, trade-offs, and deliberately choosing to be different.

- **Stress**

The real or perceived demand on the mind, emotions, spirit, or body. Too much stress puts an undo amount of pressure upon us and drives us into a state of tension. Controlled stress (arousal) is good as it is what motivates us.

- **Tannenbaum and Schmidt Leadership Continuum**

A novel and highly applicable theory categorized here as a Situational/Contingency leadership model, which focuses on the particular dimension of a leader's control emphasis according to group or followers' maturity/capability. The theory offers a sliding scale or continuum enabling selection of appropriate levels of leadership control, especially concerning delegated responsibility and group freedom. The model is especially helpful for delegation and succession management

- **Total quality management**

Describes Japanese style management approaches to quality improvement. It includes the long term success of the organization through customer satisfaction and is based on participation of all members of the organization in improving process, products, service, culture, etc.

- **Transactional leadership**

Here transactional leadership is categorised as a leadership style. As explained above, the concept and terminology of 'transactional leadership' was first described alongside a 'transforming leadership' style, by James MacGregor Burns. Transactional refers to the traditional employer/employee exchange typified by being paid to in return for doing work, extending to other incentives offered by leadership in return for extra efforts and inputs by followers. Transactional leadership is paired with the 'Transforming' style as either a way to analyse organizational

leadership cultures, but also serves as a leadership style-switch available to leaders. Transforming equates to the growth of followers via the encouragement and support to over-achieve expectations, as the main theme. ('Transforming' later became popularly 'Transformational' after the work of Bernard Bass) - see transformational and transactional leadership styles.

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Maha Malik